INTRODUCTORY SOMMELIER COURSE AND EXAM

AND

CERTIFIED SOMMELIER THEORY EXAM

CURRICULUM GUIDE

INTRODUCTORY & CERTIFIED THEORY CURRICULUM

Subject Name: BEER

Learning Outcome Introductory Sommelier Course: After studying this section, a student will know what beer is, its primary ingredients and what they contribute to a beer, the difference between an ale and lager, and examples of each.

Learning Outcome Statement Certified Sommelier Exam: A Certified Sommelier will be able recommend producers of specific styles of beer to a guest, choose the appropriate glass for specific beers, and be able to accurately answer beer costing scenarios.

	Introductory Level	Certified Sommelier Exam
Non-Wine Production: Beer	**Definition:** A fermented beverage from cereal grains (mainly barley), water, hops, and yeast.	
Ingredients		
	GRAINS/MALT: Grains for making beer- mainly barley plus other grains such as rice, corn, wheat, and oats. Grains must have their starch reserves converted to sugar for fermentation to occur. Malt provides beer with sugar for fermentation to create alcohol, plus color, flavor, body, texture, and mouthfeel.	**GRAINS/MALT** **Germination:** The process where grain kernels (seeds) produce enzymes that will turn starches into sugar for fermentation to occur. This creates malt. **Kilning: T**he heating of germinated barley to dry it and develop flavor and color. The length of time and the temperature of kilning will determine the color and flavor of the malt and the eventual beer.
	YEAST: Yeast consumes the sugars from the malt to create alcohol for fermentation to occur. Yeast can also provide aromas and flavors to beer. The type of yeast used determines if a beer is an ale or a lager: **Ales:** Top-fermenting yeasts produce ales. Creates more aromas such as fruit and spices. **Lagers:** Bottom-fermenting yeasts, clean and crisp, less effect on the aroma and flavor profile of the final beer.	**YEAST:** **Ales:** Saccharomyces cerevisiae Warm and fast fermentation (68-72°F or 20-22°C) **Lagers:** Saccharomyces pastorianus Cool and slow fermentation (48-55°F or 9-13°C)
	HOPS: The flowering cone of hop vine plant. Hops provide beer with aroma, flavor, and bitterness to balance and contrast malt sweetness. Hops act as a natural preservative with antibacterial properties. Many different varieties of hops produce a wide range of flavors and aromas.	**HOPS: Common hop variety names** American Hops: Cascade, Centennial, Citra European Hops: Hallertau, Saaz, Tettnang
	WATER: 90%+ of beer content, clean water is essential to the brewing process.	**WATER:** An important consideration for the style of beer that is produced is due to the unique mineral and ion content of various local water sources.

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	Introductory Level	Certified Sommelier Exam
Process of Production	Germination Malting Fermentation	Mashing Boiling
Label Terms / General Terms	Ale Lager	Lagering **ABV:** Alcohol by volume—an ABV of 6% means a beer contains 6% alcohol. **IBU**: International Bitterness Unit, the higher the IBUs means a more bitter beer.
Styles/Categories	Ale Examples: **Germany:** Hefeweizen **Britain:** Pale Ale, India Pale Ale (IPA), Porter **Ireland:** Irish Dry Stout **Belgium:** Lambic, Wit or White Ale Lager Examples **General:** American Lager, European Lager **Czech Republic:** Pilsner (origin of the Pilsner beer) **Germany:** Pilsner (Pils), Bock, Doppelbock, Oktoberfest	
Producer/Proprietary Brand		Producer Examples: Research and be able to recall at least two producers of common styles of beer. **Examples:** European Pale Lager American Pale Lager Pilsner American IPA American Pale Ale American or British Porter Irish Dry Stout Hefeweizen Witbier Sour Beer

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History & Lore	Beer is one of the oldest alcoholic beverages.	**Mesopotamia:** Nomadic hunter-gatherers began to settle down to farm and grow crops to make bread and beer. Beer styles are a window into time and place. Classic styles were created during very specific times in history.
Service of Beverage		Glassware must be clean polished As with wine, many styles of beer have specific and appropriate glassware for service. Recognize the name and shape of common beer glassware Pint Mug Tulip Pilsner Weizen
Food and Beer Pairing		An incredibly flexible beverage with food because of the vast arrays of possibilities with a few simple ingredients. **Understand common food and beer pairing principles:** Sweetness from malt Bitterness from hops Generally low alcohol content Carbonation or bubbles
Business of the Sommelier		**First In First Out (FIFO) for restocking.** **Beer Containers:** Bottle Can Keg (many sizes and shapes exist)
		Costing Beer **Example:** A private dining event wants to order enough kegs of a specific beer to serve on tap for a special event. There are 200 people attending. They estimate 40 percent of customers order one pint each. One pint = 16 ounces The beer is only offered in Quarter Barrel kegs; a Quarter Barrel keg = 29.3 litres/ 992 ounces How many guests order a glass of this beer? How many total ml/ounces will you need to pour throughout the evening? How many Quarter kegs must you order to ensure demand is met?

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Subject Name: SAKE

Learning Outcome Introductory Sommelier Course: After studying this section, a student will know what sake is, where it's from, its main ingredients, and the basics of how it is made. A student will learn a quality classification exists and will be able to recognize quality categories.

Learning Outcome Certified Sommelier Exam: After studying this section, a candidate will increase their knowledge of sake, sake styles, and polishing levels. A Certified Sommelier will be able to sell and recommend food pairings with sake to a guest.

	Introductory Level	Certified Sommelier Exam
Non-Wine Production: Sake	Sake is a fermented beverage made from rice. The majority of Sake production comes from Japan.	
Ingredients		
	Rice: Special varieties used for sake (not table rice).	**Rice:** Unique flavors depending on rice variety, high starch content.
	Koji-kin: A special mold native to Asia that converts starches in rice to sugar for fermentation. It is sprinkled over steamed rice.	**Koji-kin =** Aspergillus oryzae
	Yeast: Converts sugar into alcohol after the koji converts the starch to sugar. Ferments the sake and creates alcohol. Sake is typically 15-22% abv. Diverse yeast strains provide unique aromas and flavors.	Parallel Fermentation
	Water: Important component of final flavor. Each sake distillery has its own unique water source.	
	Brewer's Alcohol: Added to some styles and not others.	
Styles		**Nigori:** Cloudy Sake **Namazake:** Unpasteurized Sake **Kimoto and Yamahai**: No lactic acid added resulting in a gamey flavor.

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	Introductory Level	Certified Sommelier Exam
Label Terms / General Terms/ Classification	Sake has a classification system for the premium production. **Recognize: Junmai, Honjozo, Ginjo, Daiginjo** as being part of that classification **Junmai** = no alcohol added	Sake has a classification system for the premium production based on rice polishing. **<u>Minimum % of rice grain remaining</u>** Daiginjo: 50% Ginjo: 60% Honjozo: 70% **<u>No Alcohol Added</u>** **Junmai** Daiginjo: 50% **Junmai** Ginjo: 60% **Sake Meter Value (SMV):** The higher the number, the drier the sake. Range of -15 to +15. **Tokubetsu:** Special Sake Category
Producer/Proprietary Brand		
History & Lore		
Service of Beverage		Ginjo and Daiginjo best served chilled. Lower polishing levels, Yamahai and Kimoto can be served chilled or warm.
Food and SAKE Pairing		Kimoto and Yamahai have much more umami for pairing with bigger richer meats.
Business of the Sommelier		Sake bottle sizes: 300ml / 720ml / 1.8L